

India Kraft Fibre — Competitor & Prior-Art Scan

Has anyone in India already started this? Who is doing domestic-fibre substitution for kraft/packageg paper, how they differ from the proposed trading model, and where the open niche is.

Prepared 2 Oct 2026 · Companion to the import-substitution research & mill-trial protocol · Threat ratings are this analysis's assessment; prices/figures are indicative public data — verify directly.

VERDICT IN ONE LINE: The **idea** (use Indian fibre instead of US/EU imports) is **already active in India** — several mills and research bodies pursue it. But the specific **business model** you described — a trader who **stocks and sells a drop-in domestic long-fibre + strength-chemistry blend to the many small recycled-kraft mills, per-tonne gain-share, no machine change** — **does not appear to be occupied**. You are not first to the idea; you may be first to the model.

1 · Indian companies already substituting domestic fibre

These are the closest to the concept. Note: every one is an **integrated mill making its own finished paper** — none sells a fibre/additive blend *to other mills*, which is the key difference from the proposed model.

COMPANY / HQ	FEEDSTOCK	PRODUCTS / GRADES	SCALE	BUSINESS MODEL	OVERLAP	THREAT
Yash Pakka — Ayodhya, UP	Bagasse (from 3 nearby sugar mills)	Moulded/flexible packaging paper; CHUK compostable tableware; exports to 43 countries	~75,000 t/yr bagasse processed	Integrated manufacturer of its own branded packaging	Partial — agro fibre, but food/compostable focus, not corrugation kraft	Medium
Ruchira Papers — Kala Amb, HP	Wheat straw, bagasse, rice husk + recycled	Kraft & writing/printing; agro-residue white packaging grades	Listed mid-size mill	Integrated producer; agro-pulping lines to cut wood	Partial — agro kraft, but sells finished paper	Medium
KR Papers — Gujarat	Bagasse + agro-fibres	Kraft & packaging papers, 30+ yr	Established mid-size	Integrated producer	Partial — agro kraft in your region	Medium
NatureWrks Technologies — IIT-Madras spin-off	Agricultural waste	Ag-waste packaging materials (early commercial)	Start-up	Develops/commercialises own products	Low — different product class	Low
Amazon × IIT-Roorkee	Farm waste	Recyclable mailer/packageg (R&D; industrial trials ~2027)	R&D project	Corporate R&D, captive use	Low — not merchant fibre	Low

2 · Bamboo & long-fibre initiatives (mostly plants/policy, not a traded blend)

INITIATIVE	STATUS / WHAT IT IS	THREAT
NITI Aayog — bamboo for pulp	National policy push positioning bamboo as the substitute for imported softwood; technical sessions & roadmaps	Low (enabler)
KFRI–OBDA MoU (Nov 2025)	Kerala Forest Research Institute + Odisha Bamboo Dev. Agency — research & sector development	Low (enabler)
Bamboo pulp plant DPRs	Many feasibility studies / detailed project reports for 20,000–40,000 MT bamboo pulp & paper plants — mostly <i>proposed</i> , capital-heavy, slow	Medium (if built)
JK Paper, ITC (south/east)	Large integrated mills using wood/bamboo — not in the small recycled-kraft segment	Low (different segment)
Jute as reinforcing fibre	Documented in IPPTA research as able to replace long-fibre bamboo / imported softwood — but no commercial trader productising it for kraft mills found	Open

3 · Global chemical majors (the strength-chemistry half)

They already sell "reduce-your-fibre" dry-strength programs — but aim at **large integrated mills**, and none bundles **domestic long fibre + local stock + per-tonne gain-share for small mills**.

PLAYER	OFFER	GAP VS YOUR MODEL
Solenis / BASF (sites incl. Gujarat)	Dry-strength programs (e.g. Biobond), GPAM, PVAm	Chemistry only; big-mill focus; no fibre bundle; no small-mill local-stock + gain-share model
Kemira	Strength & process chemicals	
Ecolab / Nalco	GPAM×starch ring-crush programs	
Buckman, Ashland/Archroma	Strength resins, enzymes	
Advanced Enzyme Technologies (Thane)	Largest Indian enzyme maker; paper applications	Enzyme supplier only; you'd be a customer/partner, not a competitor

4 · Why the niche is open — idea vs model

What's TAKEN

- **Integrated agro/bamboo mills** making their own finished paper (Yash Pakka, Ruchira, KR)
- **Chemical majors** selling dry-strength to large mills
- **Government/research** pushing bamboo & agro substitution

What's OPEN (your slot)

- A **trader/"arms dealer"** — not a mill
- Sells a **drop-in blend** (domestic long fibre + chemistry) **to** the hundreds of small recycled-kraft mills
- **Warehouse-stocked, daily-priced, no shipment lag**
- **Per-tonne gain-share**, no machine change at the mill
- Serves the **under-served 16–28 BF**
Gujarat/UP/Punjab segment the majors ignore

5 · Scout before you scale (do this first)

- **Ask 5–10 mills** (your 50 associated) exactly what fibre & chemistry they buy today, and from whom.
- **Ask the chemical/enzyme suppliers** (Solenis/Kemira/Ecolab/Buckman, Advanced Enzymes) who else is trialling domestic-fibre strength programs in your belt.
- **Check local traders** in Morbi/Vapi/Ahmedabad for anyone already blending/stocking domestic long fibre.
- **Watch the bamboo DPRs** — if a 20–40k MT bamboo pulp plant comes online near you, that's a supply source *and* a potential competitor.
- **Protect the model** early: patent your specific recipe/application method; lock the first mills on gain-share before the segment is noticed.

Honest caveat: absence of public evidence is not proof nobody is doing this privately. This scan reflects publicly available information as of Oct 2026. Threat ratings are judgement calls, and company figures are indicative public data — **confirm by direct scouting and supplier quotes before committing capital.**

Sources:

Pulp & Paper Times (excess capacity; new mills) · Papermart "Beyond the Box" & "Kraft Paper: A Market in Transition" · krpapers.com (KR Papers agro-to-kraft) · Yash Pakka / CHUK public profile · Ruchira Papers agro-residue coverage · IIT-Madras NatureWrks press release · aboutamazon.com (Amazon × IIT-Roorkee) · NITI Aayog "Bamboo for Pulp & Paper" · KFRI–OBDA MoU (Nov 2025) · IPPTA "Can we use Jute" · IndexBox bamboo pulp price · PIB 2017 Forest Act amendment (bamboo not a "tree") · Ecolab/Nalco & Solenis dry-strength material · Advanced Enzyme Technologies. Full URLs in research/kraft-paper-import-substitution.md (Appendix B).